

# Hall Check Information 2025 - 2026

## Hall Check Overview

- Timelines for health & safety checks and break checks are included in this document
- Transitioning the halls from academic year housing to summer housing (generally referred to as “closing”) is a separate process; information on this process is located in the Residence Life One Drive/Closing
- Some breaks will have a scheduled Community Meeting to prepare residents; you can decide how to prepare students for other breaks

## Student Leader Presence & Position Expectations During Breaks

- Position is inclusive of hall breaks and J-Term; all responsibilities, including duty, will continue through these periods
- Student leaders may not make travel arrangements for breaks prior to discussing them with you and assuring the building responsibilities are covered
- Please do not grant any time away for student leaders without consulting with your supervisor and the live-in professional team for consistency purposes, including:
  - Leaving early or returning late from breaks (i.e. not completing break checks)
  - J-Term for those not on duty or taking classes
- We have project tasks for student leaders to complete during this time in addition to duty

## Student Leader Duty During Breaks

- I will be available for residence hall openings and remain for all hall closings and safety checks. Since halls will be open during J-Term and all breaks, including Thanksgiving, Christmas, Spring and Easter breaks, I understand that I will stay to complete room safety checks and “close” the building and may be responsible for duty coverage during all or part of those time periods. I will not make any travel arrangements for J-Term or breaks prior to discussing them with my Community/Hall Director due to my obligations in the hall. Duty coverage over all breaks is 12 hours that extends from 8 pm – 8 am. If I am on duty during time periods when all food service options are closed, I will be provided eXpress funds. During some periods, the dining halls may be closed; I understand that I may need to use my provided meal plan’s Dining Dollars when on duty over these time periods.
- eXpress funds:
  - Duty is **NOT paid**
  - \$15/day eXpress funds provided for duty days when **all** dining services are closed
  - Dates that eXpress funds will be provided are determined based on the Dining Services schedule and will be available closer to the break
  - Associate Director will indicate which duty days should receive eXpress dollars during each break
- Break Duty is 8 pm – 8 am – exact dates for start and stop of break duty hours are listed below

## Break Specific Information for 2025 - 2026

- Unless otherwise noted:
  - **Regular Duty** is 4:30 pm – 8:00 am
  - **Regular Desk Hours** are 8:00 pm – 1:00 am
  - **Break Duty** is 8:00 pm – 8:00 am
  - **Desk Closed / No Desk Staff** means desks are not staffed from 8:00 pm – 1:00 am
- Contact your supervisor / Associate Director for community specific questions

# Hall Check Information 2025 - 2026

## Opening Checks Overview (September 3 - 12, 2025):

- Health & Safety Checks: After residents move in, between Wednesday, September 3 – Friday, September 12
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: Wednesday, September 4 – Friday, September 13
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: None
- eXpress: None
- eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: NA

## Fall Break Overview (October 24 - 26, 2025):

- Break Checks: None
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: Friday, October 24 – Sunday, October 26
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: None
- eXpress: Typically not necessary
- eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: If necessary, due October 7

## Thanksgiving Break Overview (November 26 - 30, 2025):

- Break Checks: Begin Wednesday, November 26 starting no earlier than 3 pm
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: Tuesday, November 25 and Sunday, November 30
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: Wednesday, November 26 – Saturday, November 29
- Thanksgiving Break eXpress:
  - Typically provided for those on duty Thursday, November 26 – Saturday, November 29
  - eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: November 4

## Winter Break & J-Term Overview (December 19, 2025 - February 1, 2026):

- Break Checks: Begin Friday, December 29 starting no earlier than 3 pm
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: Thursday, December 18, 2025 and Friday, January 30 – Sunday, February 1, 2026
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: Friday, December 19, 2025 – Thursday, January 29, 2026
  - FY Halls can schedule 1 RA on weekends during this timeframe
  - Weekend rounds as usual (includes 2 am round)
- Winter Break eXpress:
  - Typically provided for those on duty Friday, December 19 – Monday, January 1
  - eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: December 2
- J-Term Meal Plans:
  - Student leaders are eligible to select and receive a J-Term meal plan
  - The Associate Director will send RAs meal plan options & Microsoft Forms link to request plans
- J-Term to Spring Semester eXpress:
  - Typically provided for all RAs on Saturday, January 31
  - eXpress Spreadsheet completed by Associate Director

## Spring Semester Opening Checks Overview (February 2 - 13, 2026):

- Health & Safety Checks: between Monday, February 2 – Friday, February 13
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: Monday, February 3 – Friday, February 13
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: None
- eXpress: None
- eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: NA

# Hall Check Information 2025 - 2026

## Spring & Easter Break Overview (March 27 - April 6, 2026):

- Break Checks: Begin Friday, March 27 starting no earlier than 3 pm
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: Thursday, March 26 and Monday, April 6
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: Friday, March 27 – Sunday, April 5
- eXpress: Provided for RAs on duty on Sunday, April 5
- eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: Due March 3

## End of Academic Year Overview (May 22 - 31, 2026):

- Hall Closing Checks: Closing Tasks (see Closing information)
- Regular Duty & Regular Desk Hours: through Thursday, May 21
- Break Duty & Desk Closed / No Desk Staff: Friday, May 22 – Monday, June 1 (last duty night is Sunday, May 31)
- eXpress: Typically provided for those working or on duty Saturday, May 23 – Monday, June 1
- eXpress Spreadsheet Deadline: May 5

## Language from Residence Life Handbook:

*“The purpose of Health and Safety Inspections is to ensure all student rooms and common areas are in reasonable condition and do not present health or safety hazards to individuals or the community. These inspections are conducted at least once per semester with notice given 48 hours in advance. During room inspections, Residence Life staff members will inspect the general condition of the living space including bathroom, closets, kitchens, all appliances, outlets, and fire safety equipment. Residents will be informed when health or safety violations are found and will be given the opportunity to correct violations.*

*Any illegal or prohibited items in plain view may be confiscated and referred to the Community Director / Graduate Student Assistant for judicial action. Failure to correct a violation or repeated violation of health and safety standards may result in judicial action.”*

## Communication to Residents:

- Associate Director for Operations will send all residential students an email regarding upcoming break, information on how to sign up to stay (if applicable), and information to prepare for upcoming safety checks
- Sample emails to residents are located in the Residence Life One Drive/Breaks/YEAR/Communication to Residents
- Communication for the end of the academic year to transition to summer is located in the Residence Life One Drive/Closing/YEAR

# Hall Check Information 2025 - 2026

## Conducting Health & Safety Checks:

- Preparing for Health & Safety Checks:
  - Schedule with your RA Team the specific day(s) and time(s) you'll complete Health & Safety Checks within the broader timeframe provided at the start of each semester
  - Communicate the day(s) and time(s) to residents in your community (i.e., email, Roomcompact text, in RA Group Chats, etc.)
  - Prepare a roster of all bedspaces (both occupied and unoccupied in your community), including:
    - Resident names
    - Any specific information for RAs to know (i.e., special loft requests, presence of service/emotional support animals, presence of approved air conditioner, etc.)
    - Space for RAs to note any policy violations or other concerns
  - Schedule time ahead of checks to review the process and expectations with the RAs (you can print the instructions from this document to use)
  - Check out / prepare the appropriate keys (if necessary)
- Health & Safety Check Process:
  - At least two people enter rooms together
  - Team checking rooms ensures that:
    - Space is generally clean
    - Safety:
      - Windows are working properly and screens are present
      - Door locks are working properly
    - Egress:
      - Doors open completely
      - Windows are accessible without climbing over/through furniture
    - Furniture:
      - Bed/ Lofts are assembled correctly and all bed pieces present (guard rail attached)
      - All provided furniture is present in the space
      - Space does not contain any common area furniture
    - Decoration has been completed appropriately:
      - Resident first name(s) are displayed on the door or door tag
      - No sticky strips or adhesives
      - Push pins or painter's tape only
      - Nothing in windows
      - Nothing affixed to the door (BRA, DOW, FYH, IRE, MHC, SHN)
      - Nothing hanging from the ceiling
    - Space is free from fire safety concerns:
      - Smoke detector(s) attached, functional, and uncovered
      - No candles with burned wicks
      - No extension cords or multi-plug outlets (only power strips with breaker switches allowed)
      - No appliances with open heating source (i.e., toasters, hot plates, etc.) – **non-apartment spaces only**
      - No air conditioning units (other than those approved for accommodations)
    - No animals other than:
      - Fish in small tanks
      - Approved service/emotional support animals
    - Unoccupied spaces are ready for a new resident to move in:
      - Empty rooms are empty and clean
      - Open bed spaces are free from roommates' items and clean

# Hall Check Information 2025 - 2026

- No policy violations [**in plain sight**], including:
  - Alcohol (residents under 21)
  - Drugs (including cannabis or THC products)
  - Weapons
- Team **MUST** close and ensure door is **LOCKED** after exiting
- RA Documentation & Process for Policy Violations [**in plain sight**] & Other Concerns:
  - Call Public Safety & document in Advocate:
    - Alcohol (underage residents)
    - Drugs
    - Weapons
    - Covered / Tampered with Smoke Detector
  - Document in Advocate:
    - Empty alcohol containers in spaces where underage residents reside
      - Empty cans or bottles – photograph, document, & dispose of
      - Decorations (beer can boxes on walls, bottles filled with water) – document & dispose of
    - Any animals other than fish and approved service/emotional support animals: document & work with Community Director / Graduate Student Assistant to contact resident for **immediate** removal
    - Common area furniture present (remove and return to correct space)
  - Document for CD/GSA & confiscate:
    - Candles with burned wicks
    - Unsafe appliances (i.e., toasters, hotplates, etc.) – ***non-apartment spaces only***
    - Extension cords & multi-plug outlets
    - Live Christmas trees
    - Rotting pumpkins from Halloween (**dispose of**)
    - Things hanging on sprinklers (**carefully remove**)
  - Document for CD/GSA:
    - Missing or tampered with window or screen
    - Door or window egress concerns
    - Furniture assembled improperly / missing bed guard rails
    - Decoration concerns
    - Cleanliness concerns
    - Concerns about unoccupied rooms / bed spaces
  - Confiscated Items Process:
    - Personal items labeled with room number using blue tape and left in RA Leadership Room
    - Common area furniture returned to its correct space
- Community Director / Graduate Student Assistant Responsibilities:
  - During checks:
    - Spot check process – lay eyes on at least one room for each team
    - Check lounges, hallways & common areas:
      - Cleanliness
      - Arranged properly (furniture where it should be, etc.)
      - Ensure any out-of-date posters and signage are removed
    - Be present to answer questions & assist with any documentation
    - Ensure confiscated items are marked with appropriate room number and stored
  - After Checks:
    - Collect forms and appropriate keys from student leaders
    - Note which rooms still need to be checked & compare to late stay / break stay list

# Hall Check Information 2025 - 2026

- Work with on duty RA to finish checks over the next couple days
- Follow Up on Policy Violations:
  - Public Safety Called and/or Documented in Advocate: Follow standard conduct process
  - Animals other than fish or approved service/emotional support animals:
    - If student is present:
      - Tell student the animal needs to be removed from the hall immediately (today); can mean it goes home to family, to a shelter, etc. – it **cannot** remain in the hall overnight
      - Set a time for the following morning to return to the space and confirm the animal is no longer there
    - If student is not present:
      - Call student and require them to return to the hall immediately to collect their animal
      - Tell student the animal needs to be removed from the hall immediately (today); can mean it goes home to family, to a shelter, etc. – it **cannot** remain in the hall overnight
      - Set a time for the following morning to return to the space and confirm the animal is no longer there
  - Confiscated Personal Items:
    - Send email to space resident(s) letting them know RAs confiscated the item(s), the reason the item is not allowed (likely fire-safety), and when they can pick up the item
      - Template: [Confiscated Items Email Template.docx](#)
    - We must hold onto items for 30 days unless resident indicates we can discard
    - Students must take confiscated item directly off campus
  - Space Concerns (i.e., egress, cleanliness, improper decoration, bed assembly):
    - Send email to space resident(s) letting them know RAs noted the concern, they need to address the concern immediately, and that RAs (and/or you) will return to the space at a scheduled time to ensure space is remedied
      - Template: [Space Concern Email Template.docx](#)
    - Return with an RA at scheduled time to ensure space is remedied

## Conducting Break Checks:

- Preparing for Break Checks:
  - Schedule time with your RA Team to complete Break Checks (**may begin no earlier than 3 pm**)
  - Prepare a roster of all bedspaces (both occupied and unoccupied in your community), including:
    - Resident names
    - Any specific information for RAs to know (i.e., special loft requests, presence of service/emotional support animals, presence of approved air conditioner, etc.)
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  - Check out / prepare the appropriate keys (if necessary)

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- Plan for dinner:
  - We are sometimes given permission to order food from off campus if all dining options are closed
  - Associate Director will send email if permission is granted to include with your Wells One reconciliation
  - Dinner Guidelines:
    - Delivered or picked up after 5 pm (this is the time we use for ordering approval)
    - Maximum of \$15/person present
    - Reconciled to 61430
- Break Check Process:
  - At least two people enter rooms together
  - If students are **leaving** for break:
    - Teams check **empty** rooms that have been vacated for break
    - If students are not leaving until a later date, we need to go back to that room after they have vacated
  - If students are **staying** for the break, we will conduct the checks even if students are present
  - Team checking rooms ensures that:
    - Break tasks completed:
      - All windows are closed and locked (all screens are present)
      - Blinds down / shades twisted open
      - All lights are turned off
      - Garbage and recycling cans are emptied (if not empty, remove and document)
      - Appliances are unplugged (except for fish tanks, fridges, and microwaves)
      - Heat / radiators are set to low (70 – 80 degrees)
    - Space is generally clean
    - Safety:
      - Windows are working properly and screens are present
      - Door locks are working properly
    - Egress:
      - Doors open completely
      - Windows are accessible without climbing over/through furniture
    - Furniture:
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      - All provided furniture is present in the space
      - Space does not contain any common area furniture
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